

I once watched an anime called Serial Experiments Lain, which presented an intriguing perspective: the knowledge accumulated by humanity has grown so vast that merely learning it all could take decades, leaving perhaps only a mere ten to twenty years for true innovation. If there were a massive database storing all knowledge, accessible to anyone on demand, the pace of technological advancement would accelerate exponentially. The anime's antagonist employed a special method to connect human consciousness to the network directly, transforming humans into true digital lifeforms capable of instantly accessing and comprehending any required knowledge. While this might not be feasible in reality (perhaps someday?), humanity has already begun building the most fundamental knowledge databases. The emergence of AI tools has even allowed us to preview this “on-demand” potential ahead of schedule. Incidentally, this anime aired in 1998—a time when smartphones didn’t even exist.